

Killer Rigs

Our regular monthly round-up of the best components for your rig across budgets

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Find out the latest prices of phablets, tablets and smartphones over the ₹15,000 price bracket

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Everything for your smartphone

Add bling to your smartphone with these fun accessories

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Smartphones today have become all round devices. Apart from the usual texting and making calls, smartphones connect users to their social networking accounts, act as dedicated GPS devices, can be used for multimedia, portable gaming and have effectively replaced your average point and shoot camera.

If you thought that was enough, wait till you come across some funky accessories I have found for them.

Bluetooth headset

A Bluetooth headset is the most basic accessory you will need with your smartphone. It is ideal for those who are on the move and like to keep their hands free for other activities (get your mind out of the gutter!). For this I recommend the Jabra Stone 2. It has some cool features like answering or rejecting calls with voice commands, verbal setup instructions, caller ID and battery level (verbal) indications. It can also dictate GPS directions. It comes with a charging stone letting you charge the headset on the go. You can pick it up for ₹8,000.

Portable Charger

Lets face it, with all the functionality a smartphone offers users today, the one thing that it lacks is a good battery backup. This is where a portable charger makes sense. I recommend you take a look at the Nokia Universal Portable Charger DC-16. To start with, it packs in a 2200mAh battery. This capacity is good considering that most phones pack in a 2000mAh battery at best. You can charge a smartphone completely in roughly 2 and half hours. For ₹1,499 this is definitely a steal.

Headphones

The bundled earphones with smartphones aren't the best especially if you are a music buff. But having a nice pair of headphones that also double up with answering calls really makes it a value for money device. The Bose AE2i headphones comes to mind. Not only are they comfortable to wear and produce some fantastic sound, but they also have controls for music as well as calls so you can seamlessly answer calls without having to remove the headphones. Expect to shell out ₹8,888 for these babies.

Removable iPhone lens

Yes, the camera of the iPhone is one of the best when compared to the competition but it has a long way to go before it can appeal to a professional. Additional lenses from olloclip is just what the doc ordered. You get a three-in-one lens – fisheye, wide-angle and macro. If you are one who loves shooting images with your iPhone, then this is a must have accessory for you. You can expect to pay \$70 (₹4,000 approx.) for this accessory.

A rugged case

Doesn't it break your heart when you drop your smartphone and see that big scratch along the side or back? Well, not anymore. There are a variety of tough cases available from OtterBox for most of the popular smartphones available in the market. These cases are priced around the \$35 (Rs. 2,000 approx.) and are a real value for money proposition especially if you are one who likes to carry their smartphone wherever they go, including mountain climbing.

Smartphone car mount

If you get lost easily, then the GPS and maps app on your smartphone is a lifesaver. To ensure that you don't drive into a wall while checking your phone, we suggest that you take a look at a car mount for your smartphone. Ranging from ₹1,200 to ₹4,000, there are a number of car mounts available. Some are generic and can house smartphones of various build and sizes such as the Griffin Window Car Mount for smartphones priced at ₹1,500. Some of the universal mounts can house PMP's as well. 

